

CredRisk.AI

AI-Driven Credit Risk Assessment Platform

for European Banks and SMEs

Pitcher Bier

May 17, 2026

“To become the place to be for banks and SMEs in Europe to assess the credit risk of loan applicants.”

Contents

1	Executive Summary	3
2	Mission, Vision & BHAG	3
2.1	Mission	3
2.2	Vision	3
2.3	Big Hairy Audacious Goal (BHAG)	3
3	Problem Description	4
3.1	Summary	4
3.2	Current Inefficiency	4
4	Target Audience	4
4.1	Primary: Banks and Lenders	4
4.2	Secondary: SMEs and Their Advisors	4
4.3	Tertiary: Adjacent Stakeholders	5
5	Conceptual Innovation	5
5.1	Concept	5
5.2	Illustrative Example: A €2M Logistics Loan	5
5.3	Technology Stack	6
5.4	Why This Works	6
6	Product Offerings & Use Cases	6
6.1	Core Offerings	6
6.2	Use Cases	6
7	Market Analysis	7
7.1	Market Context	7
7.2	Competitive Landscape	7
7.3	Positioning	7
8	SWOT Analysis	7
9	Revenue Model	8
10	Marketing & Go-to-Market Strategy	8
10.1	Initial Focus	8
10.2	Channels	8
11	Team Structure	8
12	Roadmap & Milestones	9
13	Financial Projections & Funding	9
13.1	Funding Strategy	9
13.2	Indicative Projections (Year 1–5)	9
13.3	Key Cost Drivers	10
14	Key Success Factors	10

1 Executive Summary

CredRisk.AI is an AI-driven credit risk assessment platform that closes the information gap between SMEs and lenders. By combining real-time financial data using Open Banking (PSD2), accounting integrations, and contextual market signals, CredRisk.AI can generate dynamic, forward-looking credit scores that traditional, manual underwriting can not match.

Our platform serves two complementary audiences. Banks and credit funds use CredRisk.AI to underwrite faster, price risk more accurately, and lower the operational cost of SME lending. Our platform can also function as a SaaS where SMEs can use the platform to understand their own creditworthiness, prepare for loan applications, and monitor their financial health.

As more lenders and businesses adopt the platform, CredRisk.AI accumulates an anonymised, ever-growing dataset of SME financial behaviour. This data network effect compounds model accuracy over time and creates a defensible competitive moat: the more participants on the platform, the better the risk insights for everyone.

Our long-term ambition (BHAG) is to be the default infrastructure for SME credit risk assessment in Europe.

2 Mission, Vision & BHAG

2.1 Mission

To eliminate information asymmetry in SME lending by giving lenders and businesses access to real-time, AI-driven credit risk insights.

2.2 Vision

A European SME lending market in which credit decisions are fast, transparent, and based on a complete and current picture of risk, so that viable businesses get the capital they need.

2.3 Big Hairy Audacious Goal (BHAG)

To become the place to be for banks and SMEs in Europe to assess the credit risk of loan applicants within ten years.

3 Problem Description

3.1 Summary

- SME lending suffers from information asymmetry and fragmented data.
- Credit assessment is manual, slow, and costly.
- Heavy reliance on historical financials produces poor real-time risk insight.

Consequence: Mispriced risk, limited SME access to capital, and high operational costs for lenders.

3.2 Current Inefficiency

When a small or medium-sized enterprise applies for a loan, the process is rarely seamless. The business owner submits financial statements, supporting documents, and projections, after which the application enters a largely manual evaluation process within the bank. Analysts gather information from multiple disconnected sources, reconcile inconsistencies, and form a judgement based primarily on historical financial performance.

This process is inherently limited. Much of the relevant information about a firm's current situation and future outlook is either fragmented across systems or not captured at all. As a result, a significant degree of information asymmetry persists between borrower and lender.

The reliance on backward-looking financial data means that credit assessments often fail to reflect real-time developments. Changes in market conditions, operational disruptions, or newly secured business opportunities are not immediately incorporated into the decision-making process. Therefore, risk is frequently mispriced, viable SMEs face restricted access to capital, and lenders incur high operational costs due to the time-intensive nature of the process or lenders are exposed to higher risk than necessary.

4 Target Audience

CredRisk.AI is designed for two clearly defined audiences.

4.1 Primary: Banks and Lenders

- Decision makers: CFOs, Chief Risk Officers, Heads of SME / Commercial Banking.
- Users: Credit analysts, underwriters, portfolio managers.
- Pain points addressed: Slow underwriting cycle times, high cost-to-serve in SME segments, regulatory pressure on risk models, margin compression.

4.2 Secondary: SMEs and Their Advisors

- Decision makers: SME owners, CFOs, controllers, external accountants.

- Pain points addressed: Lack of insight into their own risk profile, slow and opaque loan application processes, mismatch between perceived and assessed creditworthiness.

4.3 Tertiary: Adjacent Stakeholders

Fintech lenders, credit funds, factoring providers, trade credit insurers, and accountancy firms that benefit from richer and real-time SME risk data.

5 Conceptual Innovation

5.1 Concept

CredRisk.AI is an AI-driven platform that aggregates real-time financial and contextual data to generate dynamic credit scores. The service is dual-sided: bankers gain better insights and recommendations for loan decisions, while businesses gain visibility into their own financial health and expected risk rating.

In the short term, the platform helps individual lenders and applicants make better-informed decisions. In the long term, CredRisk.AI evolves into an ecosystem that reduces information asymmetry through anonymised, aggregated data. By partnering with banks, we make the platform attractive and easy to adopt for businesses. As participation grows, we accumulate financial and contextual data (including board-level and operational signals) that continuously improves our models, fraud detection, and benchmark scores.

A potential future extension is to offer our highly accurate models for use, so SMEs can also use the output of our models and gain insights in their own forecasts.

5.2 Illustrative Example: A €2M Logistics Loan

Consider a mid-sized logistics company applying for a €2 million loan.

Traditionally, the bank evaluates the company based on historical financial statements, such as revenue, profitability, and leverage ratios. This is static and may overlook recent developments or forward-looking risks.

Using CredRisk.AI, the assessment becomes dynamic and comprehensive. In addition to financial data, the platform incorporates real-time and contextual information, such as supply chain disruptions, fuel costs, and management decisions discussed in company updates. In this case the platform detects that (i) fuel costs have recently increased, negatively affecting margins, (ii) the company has secured a new long-term contract with a large client, and (iii) management has outlined a cost-reduction strategy expected to take effect within the next two quarters.

The AI integrates these signals into a forward-looking risk profile. While current ratios suggest moderate risk, the assessment is adjusted downward in the short term due to cost pressures, but recognises medium-term improvements due to the new contract and strategic adjustments. The bank receives a nuanced risk assessment, and the company gains insight into how its future outlook influences its creditworthiness.

5.3 Technology Stack

- Open Banking APIs (PSD2) for real-time transaction data
- Accounting integrations with big ERP systems (e.g., Exact, Twinfield, Visma, Xero)
- Chamber of Commerce (KvK / CoC) and registry data
- Machine learning risk models with continuous retraining
- Explainable AI layer for regulatory and analyst transparency

5.4 Why This Works

- Reduces information asymmetry between lender and borrower
- Data-driven decisions reduce human error and analyst bias
- Enables scalable, automated underwriting
- Uses real-time data instead of static, backward-looking reports
- Reduces workload for understaffed credit and risk departments

6 Product Offerings & Use Cases

6.1 Core Offerings

- Risk Score API: Real-time credit risk score for any onboarded SME, consumable by a bank's existing underwriting workflow.
- Underwriter Workbench (SaaS): Web application for credit analysts with dashboards, peer benchmarks, scenario analysis, and explainability reports.
- SME Self-Service Portal: A dashboard that lets SMEs see their CredRisk score, understand its drivers, and simulate the impact of operational decisions.
- Portfolio Monitoring: Continuous monitoring of existing loan portfolios for early warning signals.
- Benchmark & Industry Insights: Anonymised sector benchmarks delivered to lenders and corporate clients.

6.2 Use Cases

- Loan origination: Faster, more accurate SME credit decisions.
- Pricing and structuring: Risk-based pricing supported by forward-looking signals.
- Portfolio surveillance: Early warning system on existing exposures.
- Fraud and anomaly detection: Pattern recognition over real-time transaction data.
- Trade credit and supplier risk: Assessing the financial health of customers and suppliers.

7 Market Analysis

7.1 Market Context

SME lending in Europe represents one of the largest, most fragmented, and most underserved segments in financial services. SMEs account for the majority of employment and value added in the EU, yet they consistently report difficulty accessing capital. Margin pressure on banks, combined with regulatory expectations on risk modelling (e.g., IRB, IFRS 9), is forcing lenders to modernise their credit assessment stacks.

7.2 Competitive Landscape

The market is currently served by several adjacent solutions, none of which combine real-time data, dynamic scoring, and a dual-sided platform model:

Category	Examples	Limitations
Traditional credit bureaus	Graydon, Dun & Bradstreet, Creditsafe	Backward-looking, slow refresh cycles
Fintech underwriting	October, Funding Circle, iwoca	Vertical lending products, not a platform
Risk scoring fintechs	CRIF, Experian Commercial	Bureau-style scores, limited contextual data

7.3 Positioning

CredRisk.AI sits at the intersection of these categories: a real-time, AI-driven scoring layer with a dual-sided platform that includes both lenders and SMEs, building a proprietary dataset that no incumbent currently owns.

8 SWOT Analysis

Strengths	Real-time data ingestion via PSD2 and accounting APIs; forward-looking AI scoring; dual-sided value proposition for banks and SMEs; data network effect compounds accuracy over time.
Weaknesses	Early-stage brand and limited initial dataset; dependence on third-party data providers; need for regulatory credibility before banks adopt at scale.
Opportunities	European banks under margin and regulatory pressure; growing SME demand for transparent credit; consolidation of open banking; expansion into trade credit.
Threats	Established credit bureaus moving into real-time data; large banks building in-house equivalents; regulatory changes around AI (EU AI Act) and data sharing; cybersecurity and data breach risk.

9 Revenue Model

CredRisk.AI uses a layered revenue model that evolves with the maturity of the platform.

- SaaS subscriptions for lenders using the Underwriter Workbench (tiered by seats and portfolio size).
- Pay-per-use fees for individual credit assessments, attractive for smaller lenders and fintechs.
- API usage fees for banks embedding the Risk Score API in their own systems.
- Assessment bundles for predictable volume pricing.
- Premium data and benchmarks: paid access to sector and peer benchmarking reports.
- Freemium SME tier: free baseline score for SMEs, paid tier for advanced simulation and monitoring.

10 Marketing & Go-to-Market Strategy

10.1 Initial Focus

We focus first on mid-sized European banks, fintech lenders, and credit funds where the cost of bespoke in-house models is high but adoption cycles are shorter than at market leading banks. The Netherlands and DACH region offer a strong entry point thanks to mature open banking, dense SME activity, and a receptive fintech ecosystem.

10.2 Channels

- Direct enterprise sales to risk and credit leadership at target lenders.
- Strategic partnerships with accounting software vendors (Exact, Twinfield, Visma) and bookkeepers.
- Thought leadership: whitepapers, regulatory briefings, and conference presence.
- SME acquisition via accountant referral programmes and embedded experiences within accounting tools.

11 Team Structure

CredRisk.AI is built around four core functions:

- Leadership: CEO, CTO, Chief Risk & Compliance Officer, Chief Commercial Officer.
- Product & Engineering: Data engineers, platform engineers, product managers, UX designers.
- Risk & Data Science: Credit risk specialists, model validators, ML engineers/data scientists, regulatory experts.

- Commercial & Operations: Enterprise sales, partnerships, customer success, marketing, finance, legal.

12 Roadmap & Milestones

- Phase 1 – Foundation (0–6 months): MVP with data ingestion (PSD2 + accounting), baseline scoring model, first design partners.
- Phase 2 – Bookkeeping Integrations (6–12 months): Production integrations with major accounting platforms; SME self-service portal in beta.
- Phase 3 – Registry & Context (12–18 months): Chamber of Commerce integration, contextual data sources, explainability layer.
- Phase 4 – Lender Pilot (12–18 months): Paid pilots with two to three lenders; full Underwriter Workbench.
- Phase 5 – Platform (18–36 months): Network effect activation through anonymised benchmarks, expansion across the EU, ecosystem partnerships.

13 Financial Projections & Funding

13.1 Funding Strategy

- Pre-seed / Seed: Approximately €1.5–2.5M to fund MVP development, first integrations, initial team, and regulatory groundwork. Targeted at fintech-focused angels and seed funds in the Benelux / DACH region.
- Series A: Approximately €8–12M once two to three paying lenders are live, to fund commercial expansion and model investment.
- Strategic capital: Potential later-stage participation from banks and credit funds with whom we have operating relationships.

13.2 Indicative Projections (Year 1–5)

The following figures are directional and will be refined as design partners are signed.

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Lender customers	2	6	15	30	60
SMEs on platform	1k	10k	50k	150k	400k
ARR (indicative)	€0.2M	€1.5M	€5M	€14M	€30M
Gross margin	50%	65%	72%	78%	80%
Headcount	12	25	45	75	120

13.3 Key Cost Drivers

Talent (ML and risk specialists), data and infrastructure costs, regulatory and compliance, enterprise sales, and security / audit certifications.

14 Key Success Factors

- Access to high-quality, real-time data via PSD2 and accounting integrations.
- Demonstrable model accuracy and explainability, validated against incumbent benchmarks.
- Early partnerships with lenders willing to co-design and pilot.
- Trust: regulatory credibility, security posture, transparent AI.
- Building an SME community whose participation fuels the data network effect.